

Northwind Meridian Logistics

Global Travel and Expense (T&E) Policy

Document NML-FIN-07 · Version 5.1 · Effective 1 March 2026 · Owner: Corporate Finance

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy governs business travel and the reimbursement of travel-related expenses. It applies to all employees and to contractors engaged for more than 90 days. Interns are covered only when their travel has been pre-approved in writing by their department head.

This policy does not apply to members of the Board of Directors, whose travel is governed by policy NML-GOV-02.

2. Definitions

Traveler Tier. Every traveler is assigned one of three tiers:

- **Tier A** – Directors, Vice Presidents and above.
- **Tier B** – Managers and Senior Engineers.
- **Tier C** – All other staff, including contractors and interns.

TCard. The company-issued corporate travel card, used for all travel bookings and on-trip expenses.

PCard. The company-issued purchasing card, used only for approved office and supply purchases. The PCard is not a travel card.

Long-haul. Any single flight segment with a scheduled flight time of more than 6 hours. A segment of 6 hours or less is short-haul.

Approver of record. The traveler's direct manager. If a single expense report exceeds 5,000 USD, the approver of record is instead the owner of the traveler's cost center.

3. Air Travel

3.1 Class of Service

Tier	Short-haul (6 hours or less)	Long-haul (more than 6 hours)
Tier A	Economy	Business
Tier B	Economy	Premium Economy
Tier C	Economy	Economy (Premium Economy permitted if the segment exceeds 10 hours)

3.2 Advance Booking

Flights must be booked at least 14 days before departure. Bookings made 7 to 13 days before departure require a written justification attached to the booking. Bookings made fewer than 7 days before departure require Vice President approval.

Customer-emergency travel is exempt from all advance-booking rules in this section.

3.3 Loyalty Programs

Travelers may keep frequent-flyer miles earned on business trips. However, selecting a flight in order to earn miles is prohibited when that flight costs more than 150 USD above the lowest logical fare.

4. Lodging

4.1 Nightly Hotel Caps

The caps in this table were superseded on 1 June 2026 by Addendum B (see the final page of this document).

City Group	Cities	Cap per night
Group 1	New York, London, Zurich, Tokyo	420 USD
Group 2	Berlin, Singapore, Toronto, Sydney	310 USD
Group 3	All other cities	190 USD

4.2 Extended Stays

Any stay longer than 14 consecutive nights in the same city must use a corporate apartment booked through the Travel Desk. Hotels are not reimbursed for such stays.

5. Meals and Per Diem

5.1 Domestic Per Diem (travel within the United States)

Tier	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Daily maximum
Tier A	25 USD	35 USD	80 USD	140 USD
Tier B	20 USD	30 USD	65 USD	115 USD
Tier C	18 USD	25 USD	55 USD	98 USD

5.2 International Per Diem (travel outside the United States)

Tier	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Daily maximum
Tier A	30 USD	40 USD	95 USD	165 USD
Tier B	25 USD	35 USD	75 USD	135 USD
Tier C	20 USD	30 USD	60 USD	110 USD

5.3 Provided Meals and Alcohol

When a meal is provided by a conference, client or airline, the traveler must deduct the listed rate for that meal from the daily maximum. Alcohol is not reimbursable, except at client entertainment events approved in advance, where it is capped at two drinks per attendee.

5.4 Travel Days

On the day of departure and the day of return, travelers receive 75% of the applicable daily maximum instead of the full amount.

6. Ground Transportation

Ride-share services are preferred over taxis. Rental cars must be compact class, unless three or more employees are travelling together, in which case a midsize car is permitted.

Use of a personal vehicle is reimbursed at 0.67 USD per mile in the United States and 0.42 EUR per kilometre in the European Union. Mileage is not reimbursed for the commute between the traveler's home and their regular office.

Airport parking is reimbursed up to 25 USD per day. Valet parking is never reimbursable.

7. Expense Submission

Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of the end of the trip. Reports submitted between 31 and 60 days after the trip require approval from the cost-center owner. Expenses submitted more than 60 days after the trip are forfeited and will not be reimbursed.

An itemized receipt is required for any single expense of 40 USD or more. Per-diem meals do not require receipts. Lodging always requires a receipt, regardless of the amount.

If a receipt is lost, the traveler may submit Missing Receipt Affidavit form MRA-3. Each traveler may use form MRA-3 no more than twice per calendar year.

8. Corporate Cards

All travel expenses must be charged to the TCard. The PCard must never be used for travel expenses, including hotels, flights and meals. Using the PCard for a travel expense results in suspension of the PCard for 90 days on the first offense.

Personal charges placed on the TCard by mistake must be repaid to the company within 10 business days.

9. Contacts

Team	Handles	Internal extension
Travel Desk	Bookings, corporate apartments, itinerary changes	4417
Expense Audit	Report reviews, MRA-3 forms, card disputes	4480
Corporate Finance	Policy interpretation	4471

Addendum B – Lodging and Air Revisions

Effective 1 June 2026 · Approved by the Finance Committee

Addendum B supersedes the nightly hotel caps in Section 4.1. The current caps are:

City Group	Cap per night
Group 1	465 USD
Group 2	330 USD
Group 3	190 USD (unchanged)

Dubai and Seoul are reclassified from Group 3 to Group 2.

For Tier C travelers, Premium Economy is now permitted on any flight segment exceeding 8 hours. This replaces the 10-hour threshold in Section 3.1.

The travel-day rule in Section 5.4 is unchanged.

Proposed Addendum C – NOT ADOPTED

Proposed Addendum C would have raised the Group 1 nightly hotel cap to 500 USD and allowed Business class for Tier B on segments exceeding 12 hours. The Finance Committee rejected this proposal on 12 July 2026. It has no effect, and the caps in Addendum B remain in force.